

Eight Must-have Open Source Software for Windows Developers

Since the release of Visual Studio Code in 2015, Microsoft tools and software have become a popular choice for most developers. There are a number of open source tools, however, that work very well with Windows, and should be used by developers who work with Windows software. Eight of these tools are discussed in this article.

The life of a developer pretty much revolves around coding. However, any generalisation is bound to be hit by exceptions, as we have several developer entrepreneurs emerging in the software industry now, like never before. Open source software helps budding enterprise developers to leverage the best software and tools to establish their businesses.

Let us discuss some of the essential open source software that all developers (pure or with entrepreneurial interests) should have in their code room. The unique features that make these

tools worth using and how they help developers are also discussed in detail.

The popular open source software that go well with Windows are discussed briefly below.

1. Visual Studio Code

Visual Studio Code (VSC) is one of the most popular tools among developers as a one-of-its-kind code editor. VSC is a lightly built source code editor. It is a potent tool and can run on Windows, Linux and MacOS.

The one thing with developing is that the moment you get an idea, you must be able to have it coded. The more you delay the job, the more you get frustrated and the coding loses its simplicity. Visual Studio does a great job in this aspect of coding. It is a code editor that never comes in your way and that's the beauty of it. The smooth edit-build-debug cycle means you can quickly get your ideas running. The built-in debugger, as shown in Figure 2, lets you speed up the usual cycle with ease.

A few remarkable features of Visual Studio Code are listed below.

- Side by side editing:** You can open as many windows as you want, be these vertical or horizontal. There is also an option to alter the behaviour of the team by having side editors, as per your choice.
- Minimaps:** This is the code outline feature that gives the developer a bird's eye view for easy navigation and understanding.
- Exceptional architecture:** VSC is an intelligent assimilation of language-specific, Web and native technologies. The internal consistency of the architecture adds to its rich customisation.

2. Postman

Postman is an API client that is used to develop, test, share and document APIs. It provides API management, construction and integration. These

